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All industries

CareEdge revises GDP growth projection for 2025-26 to 7.5%

CareEdge Rating has revised India's real GDP growth projection for 2025-26 to 7.5 per cent from an earlier estimate of 6.9 per cent, citing stronger-than-expected growth in the first half of the fiscal. The agency expects growth to moderate in the second half as the impact of export front-loading fades and consumption eases after the festive season. Nominal GDP growth is projected at 8.3 per cent in 2025-26, lower than the budgeted 10.1 per cent. Inflation is expected to remain benign, with average retail inflation seen at 2.1 per cent in 2025-26 before normalising to around four per cent in 2026-27. CareEdge Ratings expects the government to meet its 4.4 per cent fiscal deficit target, supported by higher Reserve Bank of India (RBI) dividend transfers and lower revenue spending. The rupee is expected to hover around 89-90 to the dollar in 2026-27, while early signs of a recovery in capital expenditure are visible through stronger order books and steady foreign direct investment inflows into sectors such as electric vehicles, renewables, electronics and data centres.

Food & agro-based products

FCI mulls raising Rs.250 bln

The Food Corporation of India (FCI) is exploring raising about Rs.250 billion through government-guaranteed bonds, reported Financial Express. The move aims to bridge a widening gap between budgeted allocations and higher-than-expected food subsidy expenditure in 2025-26. FCI has revised its projected 2025-26 expenditure to Rs.1.72 trillion from the budgeted Rs.1.43 trillion, driven mainly by the rising cost of carrying surplus rice and wheat stocks above buffer norms. The plan would mark a return to off-budget funding after such borrowings were discontinued in 2021.

Coffee

Coffee exports to cross USD 2 bln in 2025

Coffee exports from India are likely to cross USD 2 billion in the current calendar year 2025. In the current year as of 16 December 2025, coffee shipments have increased by 21 per cent to around USD 1.9 billion compared to USD 1.6 billion in the same period last year. This was because of an increase in global prices due to supply issues. As of 16 December 2025, coffee export volumes have declined by six per cent to 0.36 million tonnes (mt) compared to 0.39 mt in the same period last year. This was because a section of buyers in the main destination of Europe shifted to other origins which were less priced compared to the Indian coffees.

Vegetable oils & products

Soyameal exports increase by 38% to 0.3 mt during Oct-Nov 2025

Soyameal exports from India have increased by 38 per cent to 0.33 million tonnes (mt) during October-November 2025 compared to 0.24 mt in the same period last year. This was driven by strong demand from European buyers such as France and Germany. France, which imported 80,974 tonnes, was the largest buyer of Indian soyameal, followed by Germany with 60,200 tonnes. During October-November 2025, the production of soyabean meal increased by five per cent to 1.6 mt from 1.5 mt in the same period in 2024, according to the latest demand supply data released by the Soyabean Processors Association of India.

Marine foods

India's shrimp industry likely to regain global competitive edge

India's shrimp industry is likely to regain competitive edge in the global shrimp industry as long-standing supply distortions ease, according to InCred Equities. Ecuador's prior cost advantages, supported by subsidies and aggressive export policies have reduced, bringing farm-gate prices in line with India, improving its competitiveness. Proposed EU-India and UK-India trade agreements are likely to increase access to premium and value-added markets, while India retains a strong position in the US due to limited alternative suppliers. Stabilising feed costs are improving farmer profits and manufacturer margins. Export volumes are recovering, with India's US market share rising to 40 per cent. This shows resilience and reinforces India's role as a major global shrimp supplier.

Other agricultural products

Indian turmeric faces tough competition in global market

Indian turmeric is facing tough competition from Vietnam, Myanmar and some African countries, according to media reports. It is facing high rejection rates in the US and European markets. Though India dominates the global turmeric market with a share of almost 70 per cent, still it is facing tough competition. There is a need to improve the quality of turmeric by increasing the curcumin content and reducing the moisture level to less than 10 per cent, according to N Bhavani Sri, secretary, the National Turmeric Board. Farmers, particularly in key turmeric markets such as Nizamabad, Metpally and Mahaboobabad, need to be informed about methods to improve turmeric quality through active engagement by market committees.

Centre urged to increase procurement of parboiled rice from Odisha to 2.5 MMT

On 16 December 2025, a delegation of MPs, MLAs and Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) representatives from Odisha, led by Union education minister Dharmendra Pradhan, met Union consumer affairs, food & public distribution minister Pralhad Joshi. They requested an increase in the procurement of parboiled rice from two million metric tonnes (MMT) to 2.5 MMT in the interest of state farmers. The delegation stated that the prompt lifting of surplus parboiled rice by the Food Corporation of India (FCI) would significantly benefit the state's farmers while also strengthening the country's food security system.

Rice exports remain flat at USD 7.3 bln during Apr-Nov 2025

Rice exports from India have remained flat at around USD 7.3 billion during April-November 2025 compared to USD 7.29 billion in the same period last year. This was due to higher global stocks and robust crop yield across major producing countries. Rice exports from India declined by 30 per cent to USD 0.8 billion in November 2025 from USD 1.1 billion in the year-ago month. They have been hit in the current year after the US imposed higher tariffs and the economic crisis in Iran, according to media reports. Rice exporters to Iran, a key market for Basmati rice, have expressed concerns over a potential slowdown in shipments and delays in payments following the escalation of the Israel-Iran conflict. Rice exports from India increased last year due to increased stocking by countries concerned about global conflicts. However, with the situation having stabilised this year, export growth has moderated, according to Suraj Agrawal, chief executive officer, Ricevilla Group.

Union food minister asks states to create more storage facilities for foodgrains

Pralhad Joshi, the union minister of consumer affairs, food and public distribution, has asked all state governments to create more storage facilities for foodgrains to handle the rising procurement of wheat and paddy. He added that nearly 47.8 million tonnes (mt) of paddy were procured in 2014-15 and farmers were paid Rs.669.5 billion as minimum support price (MSP). However, in 2024-25, 81.3 mt of paddy were procured for Rs.1.8 trillion. The rise in procurement was because of the favourable government policies, including a sharp rise in the MSP. He noted that India now has surplus wheat and paddy and that the Centre is funding and supporting the creation of new storage capacity.

MSOPFO to establish National Onion Bhavan to ensure fair prices

The Maharashtra State Onion Producer Farmers' Organisation (MSOPFO) in Nashik is planning to establish a National Onion Bhavan to support farmers from cultivation to marketing and ensure fair pricing. the Bhavan will place key decisions about production, storage, marketing and prices in farmers'

hands, making onion farming more secure and profitable. The first phase will be built on a two-acre site in Sinnar with an estimated cost of Rs.50 million, which will be raised through contributions from farmers, according to Bharat Dighole, president of the Maharashtra State Onion Producer Farmers' Organisation. He added that the Bhavan will oversee seed research, crop monitoring and quality control. It will also create a direct sales chain to reduce middlemen and provide facilities for meetings, testing and accommodation.

Textiles

Textiles & apparel exports largely flat during Jan-Nov 2025

Exports of textiles and apparel (excluding handicrafts) stood at USD 32,560.0 million during January-November 2025, registering a marginal increase of 0.26 per cent over USD 32,474.9 million recorded in the same period last year.

Textiles & apparel exports rise 9.4% in November 2025

Textiles and apparel exports, including handicrafts, rose by 9.4 per cent to USD 2,855.8 million in November 2025 compared to USD 2,601.5 million in November 2024, according to media reports. Growth was led by readymade garments (RMG), which increased by 11.3 per cent, followed by man-made yarn, fabrics and made-ups, which grew by 15.7 per cent. Cotton yarn, fabrics, made-ups and handloom products registered a 4.1 per cent rise, while handicrafts (excluding handmade carpets) recorded a sharp growth of 29.7 per cent.

Readymade garments

RMG exports rise by 3.6% in Jan-Nov 2025

Readymade Garments (RMG) exports grew by 3.6 per cent year-on-year during January-November 2025 compared to the year-ago period, according to media reports. In November 2025, RMG exports rose by 11.3 per cent year-on-year.

Fertilisers

Rajya Sabha approves additional subsidy for fertilisers

The Rajya Sabha has approved an additional subsidy for fertilisers on 16 December 2025. It cleared the first batch of Supplementary Demands for Grants, allowing the Union Government to spend Rs.414.6 billion more, including Rs.180 billion for fertiliser subsidy.

Drugs & pharmaceuticals

AstraZeneca gets CDSCO approval to launch Datverzo

AstraZeneca Pharma India has secured Central Drugs Standard Control Organisation (CDSCO) approval to import and market Datverzo, marking the drug's entry into the domestic market for advanced breast cancer treatment. The therapy is cleared for adults with unresectable or metastatic HR-positive, HER2-negative breast cancer, including those classified as IHC 0, 1+ or 2+/ISH-, who have undergone prior endocrine and chemotherapy regimens. Commercial requirements are completed.

India's pharma exports exceed USD 30 billion

India's pharmaceutical exports exceeded USD 30 billion in 2024-25. Commerce secretary Rajesh Agrawal highlighted that India is now among the largest producers of medicines worldwide, supplying regulated and emerging markets across more than 200 countries. He also stated that the domestic pharma industry, currently valued at around USD 60 billion, is expected to expand to roughly USD 130 billion by 2030.

Novartis expands India operations for drug research & development

Novartis is expanding its India operations into a major global centre for drug research and development (R&D), with local teams now contributing to nearly all late-stage molecules in its pipeline. The company's Hyderabad and Mumbai hubs have grown to over 9,000 employees, reflecting a shift from back-end support to high-value scientific and digital innovation. India has become a core part of Novartis' global R&D model as the company deepens early-stage research, analytics and clinical development work in the country.

Petroleum products

Bathinda refinery shutdown sees LPG shortage in Punjab, Himachal

The shutdown of the Guru Gobind Singh Refinery in Bathinda has led to a shortage of liquefied petroleum gas (LPG) across Punjab, as well as parts of Himachal Pradesh and Jammu & Kashmir. Deliveries that normally took a day or two are now taking 10 days or more. With the closure coinciding with the peak demand season for LPG cylinders, the gap between supply and demand has widened, putting distributors under pressure from consumers. Currently, Hindustan Petroleum Corporation (HPCL) is sourcing supplies from Kandla. The situation is expected to normalise within a few days, as the Bathinda refinery is scheduled to resume operations on 19 December 2025, according to Abhishek Srivastava, chief regional manager, HPCL.

Personal & home care products

FMCG cos see signs of demand revival: ICICI Bank

FMCG companies are witnessing early signs of revival in demand, according to ICICI Bank. The recovery is driven by the recent goods and services tax (GST)-linked price cuts and higher promotional activity. Price cuts have led to high elasticity in discretionary categories such as beauty, lotions and shampoos. This means a small reduction in price is leading to a much higher rise in sales volume of these products. Contrastingly, staple categories such as soaps and hair oils have remained stable.

Gems & jewellery

Gold prices to touch Rs.190,000: WGC

Gold prices are expected to remain high and are likely to touch Rs.190,000 per 10 grams or USD 6.000 per ounce in 2026, according to David Tait, chief executive of World Gold Council (WGC). They stood at about USD 4,321 per ounce on 17 December 2025, reflecting a 60 per cent year-on-year rise. Expected deregulation in China, a large-scale generational transfer of wealth in Japan and accelerating adoption of exchange-traded funds (ETFs) and other gold investment products drove gold prices higher.

Silver hits Rs.200,000 per kg on 17 December 2025

Silver prices touched the Rs.200,000 per kilogram (kg) mark on 17 December 2025, rising by Rs.9,000 compared to 16 December 2025. Weaker labour data of the United States and a supply crunch led to a rise in prices. Internationally, silver prices rose by 2.8 per cent to an all-time high of USD 65.53 per ounce. However, high prices have impacted jewellery sales.

Consumer electronics

Tata Sons invests additional Rs.15 billion in its electronics business

Tata Sons invested an additional Rs.15 billion in Tata Electronics, according to media reports. This new investment has taken the total capital infusion by Tata Sons in Tata Electronics to Rs.45 billion in the last one year. Tata Electronics manufactures iPhones on contract for Apple, and most of the iPhones produced are exported to the United States and Europe.

Smartphone exports touch USD 2.7 billion in November 2025

Smartphone exports touched USD 2.7 billion in November 2025, according to media reports. Of this, Apple accounted for 75 per cent or USD 2 billion. The remaining was contributed by Samsung at USD 432 million, Padget at USD 48 million and third-party exporters. Overall smartphone exports have

increased by 43 per cent to USD 18.7 billion in the April-November 2025 period compared to USD 13 billion in the year-ago period. The production-linked incentive (PLI) scheme, introduced in 2020, has supported the growth in the export of smartphones. However, the PLI scheme has come to an end for Samsung and will also end for Apple's vendors by March 2026.

Apple exports iPhones worth Rs.2 billion in November 2025

Apple exported iPhones worth Rs.2 billion from India in November 2025, marking the highest exports in a month of 2025-26. iPhones accounted for about 75 per cent of the total smartphone exports. Overall, iPhone exports during the April-November 2025 period have crossed USD 14 billion.

Boilers & turbines

Suzlon wins 306 MW wind turbine contracts

Suzlon Energy announced that it has secured two wind turbine orders of 153 MW each from Yanara, marking the company's second repeat order from the developer this year. The deal includes the supply of 102 S144 wind turbine units for projects in Barmer, Rajasthan, supporting Yanara's renewable energy expansion. The power output from these projects will support Yanara's supply commitments under existing agreements with major buyers.

Agricultural machinery

Tractor exports rebound, set to cross 100,000 units in 2025

India's tractor exports are showing signs of recovery in 2025 after two years of subdued activity, with shipments rising six per cent in the first eleven months to 95,191 units and expected to cross 100,000 units by year-end. Improved demand across major overseas markets has lifted volumes, supported by double-digit growth from leading manufacturers such as Mahindra & Mahindra and Escorts. Industry projections indicate stable mid- to high-single-digit export growth ahead.

Automobile

Panel recommends EV incentives, not support for hybrids

A parliamentary committee has recommended that government incentives should be directed exclusively toward fully electric and zero-emission vehicles rather than hybrid cars, which still rely on fossil fuels and emit pollutants. The panel emphasised prioritising full electrification to accelerate adoption and achieve environmental goals, noting industry differences over transitional hybrid support. It also highlighted potential concerns around higher ethanol fuel blends affecting older

vehicles, underscoring that emission reduction policies should remain focused on promoting genuine zero-emission mobility.

PM EDRIVE drives EV growth with lower subsidies

The PM EDRIVE programme significantly accelerated electric vehicle (EV) adoption in India, delivering around 1.13 million EVs in its first year, while using roughly half the per-unit subsidy of the previous FAME-II scheme. In spite of the lower incentives, annual EV sales were over three times higher, highlighting stronger market uptake and improved cost efficiency. Two wheelers dominated the adoption, with commercial EV segments also seeing growth. The varying adoption across states and vehicle categories points to the importance of aligning policies, expanding infrastructure, and implementing targeted measures to sustain and broader EV growth nationwide.

Passenger vehicles

Gadkari urges car makers to focus on local sourcing and quality

India's transport minister emphasized the need for automakers to increase the use of locally made components and improve product quality, reducing reliance on imports. He highlighted that Indian auto parts are globally competitive and stressed the strategic importance of strengthening domestic manufacturing for economic growth and export potential. He also pointed out that improving vehicle quality and emission standards is crucial for addressing pollution in major cities, underlining the role of the automotive sector in both environmental and industrial development.

Year-end surge puts India's car market on track for record high

India's passenger vehicle market is set to close the year at a record level, driven by a sharp rebound in demand during the second half after a slow start. Festive season buying, improved consumer sentiment, price incentives and policy support helped accelerate sales, prompting auto manufacturers to ramp up production toward year-end. Utility vehicles continued to lead growth, while electric vehicles also saw an increase in volumes, though they still account for a small share of total sales and remain dependent on discounts and incentives. Overall, the late-year momentum is expected to push total car sales well above last year's levels, marking a strong finish for the industry.

Coal & lignite

Coal demand to rise by 3% p.a. by 2030: IEA

Coal demand in India is projected to rise by three per cent per annum by 2030, according to the International Energy Agency (IEA). The country is expected to have the largest absolute increase in coal

consumption by 2030, with a projected increase of 225 million tonnes. Globally, demand for coal is expected to plateau and decline by 2030, driven by the increasing role of renewable energy, natural gas and nuclear power.

Centre proposes to remove 50% cap on sale of coal from captive mines

The government has proposed the removal of the 50 per cent cap on the sale of coal and lignite from captive mines, according to media reports. This is aimed at clearing accumulated stockpiles and increasing availability in the market. Currently, captive mine operators can sell only 50 per cent output, leaving large amounts unused. These accumulating stockpiles create environmental and safety risks and strain space, especially at smaller mines. The proposal is part of a series of reforms to the Mines and Minerals Development and Regulation (MMDR) Act.

Coal production up 2.1% in November 2025

Coal production rose by 2.1 per cent on a year-on-year basis in November 2025, according to the coal ministry. It stood at 92.7 million tonnes (MT) in November 2025, of which Coal India accounted for 73.2 per cent. This, however, is lower in comparison to the target of 97.2 MT for the month.

Crude oil & natural gas

About 170 mn Russian barrels on water: Rystad Energy

Nearly 170 million barrels of Russian oil are currently stored at sea, according to Rystad Energy. If sanctions are lifted and trade flows return to normal, much of this oil could re-enter global markets, boosting supply. Easing sanctions would also impact pricing dynamics. The discounts on Russian crude, expanded by sanctions and trade restrictions, could shrink with the return of buyers and fewer shipping constraints. This scenario would alleviate concerns about sudden supply disruptions, which have helped keep prices high over the past three years.

Minerals

Govt notifies Rs.72.80 bn scheme for domestic production of sintered REPM

The government has notified a Rs.72.80 billion scheme to promote domestic manufacturing of sintered rare earth permanent magnets (REPM), according to media reports. This initiative aims to reduce reliance on China and strengthen critical supply chains. The scheme seeks to create an end-to-end domestic value chain for converting rare earth oxides into sintered neodymium-iron-boron (NdFeB) magnets. Additionally, it will support the establishment of 6,000 tonnes per annum of integrated manufacturing capacity. Eligible manufacturers will receive sales-linked incentives on sintered NdFeB

magnets produced from neodymium-praseodymium (NdPr) oxide, along with capital subsidies for setting up facilities. Individual beneficiaries can be allocated capacity ranging from 600 MTPA to 1,200 MTPA. The scheme will run for seven years, including a two-year setup period and five years of incentive payouts linked to sales.

Conventional electricity

Jewellery sales volume down more than 30%: PL Capital.

The jewellery industry witnessed a decline of more than 30 per cent in sales volume in spite of a robust wedding season, according to PL Capital. This decline was due to a 70 per cent increase in gold prices. However, demand is expected to rise by about seven to eight per cent during the October-March 2025-26 period, driven by a higher number of weddings. Jewellers are witnessing a shift in buying patterns as consumers are now opting for 18 or 14 carat jewellery, lightweight designs and studded pieces amid high gold prices.

Hotels & restaurants

RHG targets 150 operational hotels in 2026

The Radisson Hotels Group has set a target to have 150 operational hotels by 2026, according to media reports. The global hospitality firm's expansion plans will be driven by flexible franchise models, strategic conversions and growth across destinations like tier 2 and tier 3 cities, religious and wellness destinations.

DS Group announces expansion of Radisson Blu Guwahati

The Dharampal Satyapal Group has announced plans to expand capacity and offerings at the Radisson Blu hotel in Guwahati, according to media reports. The expansion will include the addition of another 85 rooms and the largest pillar-less convention centre in the North East region. The expansion will take the property's total capacity to 280 rooms.

Pride Hotels launches hotel in Gandhinagar

Pride Hotels announced the opening of a new hotel Pride Elite Gandhinagar, according to media reports. The hotel has a capacity of 72 rooms. Pride Hotels currently has 19 hotels operational across the state of Gujarat.

Sarovar Hotels opens hotel in Jim Corbett

Sarovar Hotels announced the launch of a new hotel Vandhara Sarovar Premiere in Patkote, Jim Corbett, according to media reports. The hotel has a capacity of 73 villas, rooms and suites.

Tourism

Rajasthan govt to introduce `Adopt a Tourism Site' scheme

The Rajasthan government is planning to introduce the 'Adopt a Tourism Site' scheme. This initiative invites private players, local communities and tourism-sector stakeholders to participate in the restoration, management & commercial operation of heritage and eco-tourism locations. The scheme is designed to reduce the government's operational burden while enhancing visitor experience through professionally developed amenities. Under the proposed structure, partners will be allowed to adopt identified tourism sites or specific amenities within them for a minimum period of five years.

Road transport services

India to launch MLFF toll collection by end of 2026

India is set to introduce Multi Lane Free Flow (MLFF) toll collection by the end of 2026, announced Union Road Transport and Highways Minister Nitin Gadkari. The MLFF system will replace Fastag. This new artificial intelligence (AI)-driven highway management system is expected to enable vehicles to pass through tolls at speeds of up to 80 km/h, without any need to stop.

Railway transport & allied services

NFR successfully handles first-ever direct inward automobile rake at Sairang Railway Station

The Northeast Frontier Railway (NFR) has achieved milestone by successfully handling the first-ever direct inward automobile rake at Sairang Railway Station, Mizoram. A total of 119 Maruti cars, transported from Changsari near Guwahati, were delivered by rail. This landmark operation by NFR will enhance goods and vehicle transportation availability in the state of Mizoram, reducing long-distance road dependence, and provide tangible benefits to automobile dealers, service providers and consumers, thereby supporting regional economic growth.

Air transport services

Delhi HC refuses PIL seeking four times refund from IndiGo for cancellation of flights

On 17 December 2025, the Delhi high court (HC) declined to entertain a public interest litigation (PIL) filed by the Centre for Accountability and Systemic Change - a think tank - seeking directions to IndiGo

to pay compensation amounting to four times the full ticket price to passengers whose flights were cancelled following the implementation of new flying norms. The think tank had sought the Centre's intervention to initiate a class action against IndiGo for the hardship and losses suffered by passengers due to recent mass cancellations and delays. It argued that lapses by IndiGo, coupled with the Directorate General of Civil Aviation's (DGCA) failure to enforce regulatory compliance, had exposed vulnerabilities in the aviation sector that could hamper the growth ambitions of 'Viksit Bharat'.

IndiGo's COO, senior officials appear before panel examining recent air traffic disruptions

On Wednesday, 17 December 2025, senior aviation officials and IndiGo COO Isidro Porqueras appeared before a parliamentary panel examining the recent air traffic disruptions tried to fix responsibility for Indigo's mass cancellation of flights. The panel, however, found the replies of the airline and Directorate General of Civil Aviation (DGCA) 'evasive and unconvincing'. It did not come to any conclusion and decided to wait for the report of the ongoing inquiry of the civil aviation ministry before fixing the onus for the chaos that left thousands of travellers stranded across the country's airports.

SpiceJet has ordered 100 of its blended-wing-body jets: Natilus

On 17 December 2025, the United States (US) aviation startup Natilus said that India's SpiceJet has ordered 100 of its blended-wing-body jets, as the company marks its entry into the fast-growing Indian market with the launch of a local subsidiary. Natilus is also considering India as one of the possible locations for a manufacturing facility, and aims to build roughly 300 HORIZON jets at the site once complete.

Telecommunication services

Indian telcos to invest over Rs.1 trillion in AI-ready data centres

Indian telecom operators are expected to invest over Rs.1 trillion in artificial intelligence (AI)-ready data centres, edge infrastructure and cloud capabilities, according to industry executives. Of the total capital expenditure planned for the financial year 2026-27, around 20-30 per cent is likely to be directed towards these areas. Over the next two to three years, the sector aims to shift its focus towards compute-intensive digital infrastructure, with the objective of increasing enterprise revenues to 40 per cent of total income, up from the current range of 15-30 per cent. Additionally, Reliance Jio and Bharti Airtel have made strategic investments in gigawatt-scale, AI-focused data centres, which could add an estimated 4-5 gigawatts (GW) to India's existing digital infrastructure. The companies are also deploying AI solutions to lower operating costs over the next 18-24 months.

Satcom companies require spectrum assignment, security clearance before starting service

Satellite communication companies are required to complete security clearance and obtain spectrum assignment before launching their services. The security clearance includes requirements to host international gateways in India. The policy framework for India's satellite communications is now firmly in place. Additionally, satcom licences have already been issued to Starlink, OneWeb and Reliance. These companies have received sample spectrum to conduct trials.

Computer software

Annualised AI revenue at USD 1.5 billion: TCS CEO

Tata Consultancy Services (TCS) has reported an annualised revenue run rate of USD 1.5 billion from artificial intelligence (AI) services, the chief executive officer (CEO) of the company, K Krithivasan said. The company has executed nearly 5,500 AI engagements for clients. The quarter-on-quarter growth of AI services has gone up by 16.3 per cent, driven by AI-led demand from BFSI, life sciences and manufacturing. Nearly 85 per cent of TCS clients with over USD 20 billion in total contract value (TCV) now use the company for AI-led transformation work. Additionally, TCS generates around USD 11 billion in revenue from next-generation services. The legacy IT services of TCS, such as application development, testing and business process services, are growing at a faster pace than the company's average growth rate. The company also plans to maintain EBITDA margins in the range of 26-28 per cent and return around 80-100 per cent of free cash flow to shareholders.

Health services

Mizoram govt to sign loan deal with ADB to strengthen Universal Health Care Scheme

The Mizoram government will soon sign a loan deal amounting to USD 108 million with the Asian Development Bank (ADB) to implement the Mizoram Universal Health Care Scheme (MUHCS). Around 90 per cent of the loan amount will be repaid by the Centre, while the state government will repay 10 per cent within 15 years. Aizawl Civil Hospital, the largest civil hospital in the state, is also being strengthened and upgraded with several facilities under the Aizawl Smart City project.

Production & distribution of films

Saregama India enters long-term partnership with Bhansali Productions

Saregama India has partnered with Bhansali Productions through a structured, long-term investment, granting it the option to acquire majority control of Sanjay Leela Bhansali's film studio by 2030. The

music company is set to invest Rs.3.3 billion in Bhansali Productions via compulsory convertible preference shares. The partnership is designed to combine Bhansali Productions' content creation capabilities with Saregama's strengths in music and live events. Under the agreement framework, Bhansali Productions will maintain full creative control and ownership of its film intellectual property, while Saregama will offer governance guidance and ensure financial control. In addition to the equity investment, Saregama has signed a music rights agreement that ensures access to all future music created and produced by Bhansali Productions. The studio currently has a slate of more than 10 feature films planned over the next three years.

Dharma Productions takes over Cornerstone's stake, rebrands talent division as DCAA

Dharma Productions has taken over the stake of Cornerstone in its talent management division, Dharma Cornerstone Agency and is entering a new phase of growth with a rebrand as Dharma Collab Artists Agency (DCAA). The expanded platform will focus on representing and developing talent across film, music, sports, digital media and live entertainment.

Bhanushali Studios joins forces with Michael Bay for upcoming Indian feature film

Bhanushali Studios has partnered with Hollywood filmmaker Michael Bay for an upcoming Indian feature film, according to media reports. Michael Bay, among the world's highest-grossing directors and the filmmaker behind blockbuster franchises like Transformers, Bad Boys and Armageddon, shared the announcement on his social media platforms. This collaboration aligns with Bhanushali Studios' strategy to expand its slate of large-scale productions and international ventures. The film is expected to combine Hollywood-scale action with Indian storytelling sensibilities. The project is currently in the early stages of development, with more details set to be revealed in the coming months.

Media-broadcasting

JioStar faces continuous losses on its ICC media rights

JioStar, the largest broadcast partner of the International Cricket Council (ICC), is facing another year of substantial losses on its ICC media rights investment, according to media reports. This is due to lower-than-expected commercial returns from major ICC events. In spite of the strong audience engagement during tournaments such as the ICC Men's T20 World Cup 2024 and the ICC Champions Trophy 2025, advertising and subscription revenues fell short of internal targets. The situation underscores a growing structural gap between high viewership numbers and commercial returns in global cricket broadcasting. The combined advertising revenue from these events exceeded Rs.20

billion, falling short of the overall target of over Rs.40 billion. In response, the ICC and JioStar are exploring restructuring options to ease annual cash flow pressures while maintaining the ICC's long-term revenue visibility.

Other recreational & allied services

J&K minister inaugurates Rs.30 mln Indoor Stadium at Khour

Jammu & Kashmir (J&K) minister for youth services and sports Satish Sharma recently inaugurated the Rs.30 million indoor stadium with multi-sports facility at Khour, Jammu. This marks a significant milestone in strengthening the sports infrastructure in the border areas of the union territory (UT). The minister claimed that the UT administration is working earnestly towards providing modern, accessible and inclusive sports facilities to youths. The focus is being accorded to the rural and border belts, to promote sports culture, discipline & healthy lifestyle. He emphasised that quality infrastructure at the grassroots level plays a crucial role in identifying and nurturing the sporting talent.

Real estate

Entry of foreign universities to boost education-related real estate

The approval for foreign universities to set up campuses in India is expected to drive strong demand in education-led real estate, including student housing, faculty accommodation, and supporting commercial infrastructure. This move is likely to attract international institutions, stimulate urban development around educational hubs, and create opportunities in retail and hospitality sectors. Over the long term, such campuses could accommodate large student populations, generating significant real estate demand and strengthening India's education ecosystem while offering attractive investment prospects.

BDA plans land auctions to raise Rs.18 billion

The Bengaluru Development Authority (BDA) is set to auction several prime land parcels, including a 52-acre commercial site, to generate up to Rs.18 billion in revenue. The move aims to strengthen the authority's finances and support urban development, leveraging strong demand from real estate developers amid limited private land availability. Bidders are required to pay a portion of the bid upfront, with the remainder due shortly after allotment, making the initiative a significant step in monetising public assets and funding city projects.

Banking services

SBI plans board-defined M&A policy and risk appetite

State Bank of India (SBI) is planning to have a board-defined mergers and acquisition (M&A) policy and risk appetite, as it is a regulatory requirement by the Reserve Bank of India, according to CS Setty, chairman. The bank will be more risk-focused in M&A financing. Additionally, it plans to collaborate with multinational banks which are already into M&A financing.

Axis Bank to tap wealth management in tier 2 cities & beyond

Axis Bank is expected to tap wealth management in tier 2 cities and beyond, according to Arnika Dixit, head of wealth management and the affluent banking unit. The bank managed Rs.6.5 trillion in wealth assets under its private banking division, Burgundy Private, as of September 2025. Out of this, around Rs.2.5 trillion was managed by Burgundy Private, which serves 15,250 ultra-high-net-worth clients with minimum investable assets of Rs.50 million. The wealth management industry is projected to double assets under management to USD 2.3 trillion by March 2029 from USD 1.1 trillion in March 2024. The bank is adding relationship managers across locations to serve the growing demand of high-net-worth and ultra-high-net-worth clients. It is also recruiting senior money managers for its private banking division, Burgundy Private.

GST cut leads to surge in retail credit demand: TransUnion CIBIL

Goods and services tax rationalisation has led to a surge in retail credit demand, according to a TransUnion CIBIL report. The rate cuts implemented in September 2025, ahead of the festive season, supported renewed consumer confidence and market optimism, resulting in higher retail loan demand. The impact was particularly visible in vehicle finance, including two-wheeler and auto loans, as well as consumer durables, which recorded strong incremental year-on-year growth during the pre-festive period following the rollout of GST 2.0.

Stablecoins undermine confidence in financial system: RBI

Stablecoins could undermine confidence in the currency and the financial system, according to T Rabi Sankar, deputy governor, the Reserve Bank of India (RBI). He warned, citing risks to monetary sovereignty, financial stability and public trust. India has little justification to adopt stablecoins, especially when existing payment systems such as the unified payments interface (UPI), real-time gross settlement (RTGS) and national electronic funds transfer (NEFT) already provide fast, secure and low-cost digital payments. Additionally, he acknowledged that the Central Bank Digital Currencies provide the similar technological benefits as stablecoins while removing their inherent risks. He noted that

stablecoins lack the basic attributes of money, offer no clear or unique advantages and carry significant risks. Moreover, he cautioned that the threat is greater if a stablecoin functions efficiently, as widespread use could erode monetary sovereignty even without any failure of its backing assets.

RBI unlikely to cut rates in February: Barclays

Barclays expects the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) to not cut the repo rate in February 2026 after an unanimous 25 basis point rate cut on 5 December 2025, as inflation dynamics turn less favourable. Although rabi sowing trends remain supportive, headline inflation is likely to exceed the RBI's near-term projections, making another early cut difficult. Inflation is estimated at around 1.55 per cent in December 2025, implying an October-December 2025 average of 0.84 per cent, above the Monetary Policy Committee's (MPC) forecast of 0.6 per cent. However, unresolved United States trade issues and secondary tariffs, could reopen the case for a follow-up cut, but in its base case the brokerage expects the MPC to hold the repo rate at 5.25 per cent in February 2026.

HDFC Bank to acquire 9.5% in IndusInd Bank

HDFC Bank, along with its group entities, will acquire up to a 9.5 per cent stake in IndusInd Bank, according to media reports. HDFC Bank received approval from the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) on 15 December 2025 and it will remain valid till 14 December 2026. The approval covers HDFC Bank and its group entities.

Insurance services

Insurers likely to get direct equity access to unlisted companies

Insurers, which collectively manage over Rs.70 trillion in assets, may soon be permitted to invest directly in unlisted companies if Parliament passes a proposed bill that removes existing exposure limits on such investments, according to media reports. The move would align insurers with other state-backed institutions like the National Bank for Financing Infrastructure and Development and infrastructure sponsors such as NTPC. Currently, insurers can invest in approved and other instruments, including equity shares, debentures, bonds and infrastructure assets, subject to strict conditions on credit ratings, track record and prudential exposure limits. The proposed amendment does not affect insurers' ability to invest through alternative investment funds (AIFs), where exposure caps already apply.

Rajya Sabha clears bill to allow 100% FDI in insurance

The Rajya Sabha, on 17 December 2025, passed the Sabka Bima Sabki Raksha (Amendment of Insurance Laws) Bill, 2025, aimed at increasing insurance penetration and achieving universal insurance

coverage by 2047, according to media reports. The bill proposes to raise the foreign direct investment (FDI) limit in the insurance sector from 74 per cent to 100 per cent. It also allows the merger of non-insurance companies with insurance firms and provides for the creation of a Policyholders' Education and Protection Fund to safeguard policyholders' interests. The amendments are expected to improve ease of doing business for insurers, intermediaries and other stakeholders, enhance transparency in regulation-making, and strengthen regulatory oversight of the sector. The bill also revises the tenure of the chairperson and whole-time members to five years or until the age of 65 years, whichever is earlier. Currently, the upper age limit is 62 years for whole-time members and 65 years for the chairperson.

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